

RATE CARD & NEGOTIATION GUIDE

Know your worth • Maximize margins • Walk away from bad deals

STANDARD MINIMUM ACCEPTABLE RATES

Job Type	Minimum Rate	Notes
Mortgage Occupancy	\$10-\$15	Drive-by only; add premium for interior access
Commercial Mystery Shop	\$25 + reimbursements	Video/ADA shops command \$50-200+
Property Preservation (Manual Labor)	\$28-\$50 (grass cut) \$70-\$100 (dry winterization)	Wet winterization: \$105-\$250
Specialized Documentation (High Liability)	\$100-\$300 (loss draft) \$75+ (REO lockout/CFK)	Premium rates reflect technical knowledge and liability

HOW TO NEGOTIATE PREMIUM RATES

Strategy	Application	Premium Justification
Rush Surcharge	Insurance Loss Drafts requiring 1-6 hour appointment setting	Charge \$25-\$50 "Rush" premium for 24-hour turnaround
Materials vs. Installed Doctrine	Contractor pressures you to sign off on 100% completion for draw	Your objectivity (only documenting attached work) is worth premium to lender
Hazardous/Distance Premiums	Disaster or rural REO work	Negotiate trip fees based on mileage beyond 20-mile radius
Technical Complexity	ADA compliance audits requiring specialized equipment	Level/pressure gauge expertise justifies \$100-200+ rates

WHEN TO WALK AWAY

If a firm offers under \$10 for a job requiring interior access, a homeowner signature, or specific equipment (like a digital level), **walk away**. Your time is better spent stacking mystery shops with medical parcel pick-ups on the same route.

Red Flag	Why It's Bad	Better Alternative
\$5-10 for interior inspection	Hourly rate drops below minimum wage when drive time included	Stack 3-4 exterior-only jobs on same route at \$15 each
No mileage reimbursement for 50+ mile jobs	Fuel costs eat entire profit margin	Negotiate \$0.50/mile or decline
"We'll pay you when we get paid"	Net-30 or Net-60 terms kill cash flow for solopreneurs	Work only with firms offering weekly or biweekly direct deposit

